I STOLE AN ABSURD AMOUNT OF MONEY FROM JEFF BEZOS AND NOW EVERY AMAZON EMPLOYEE IN THE CITY IS CHASING ME!

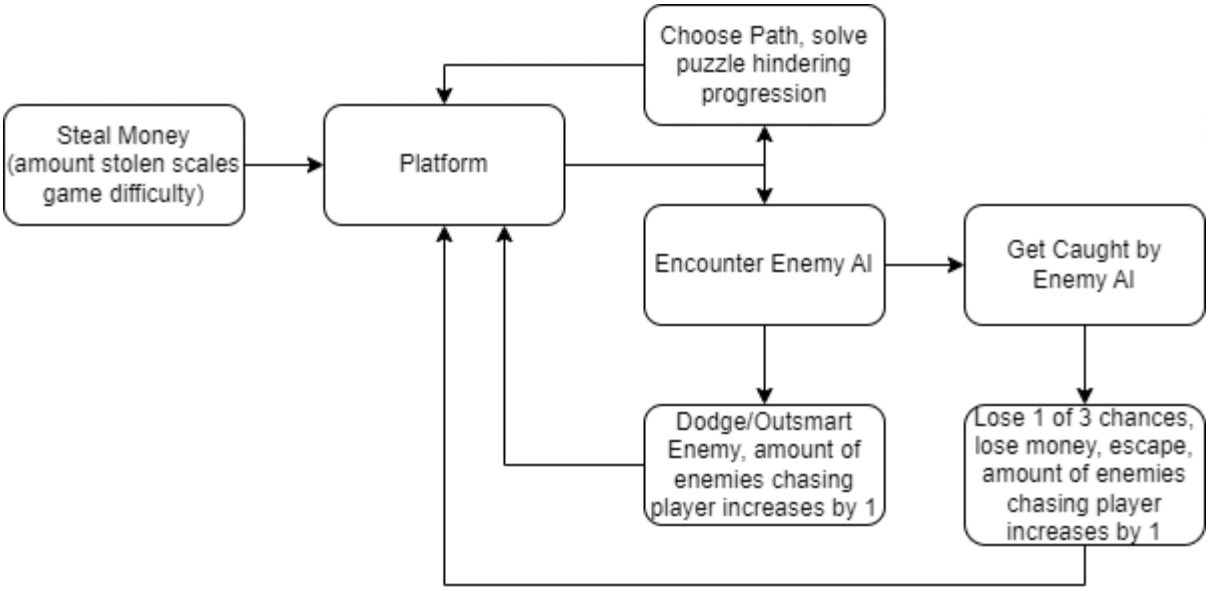
General Game Premise

The idea for this game is to make the player feel like a master thief in the middle of a chase sequence through a combination of a mastery of the movement mechanics, level design, and interactions with the enemy AI.

The game is a 2D Metroid-Vania inspired fast-paced action platformer with set levels and branching paths aimed at players who enjoy platformers such as 'Celeste', 'Sonic Mania', 'Katana Zero', and 'Hollow Knight', and also shares influences from 'Metal Gear Solid', 'WarioLand' and 'Castlevania' among others.

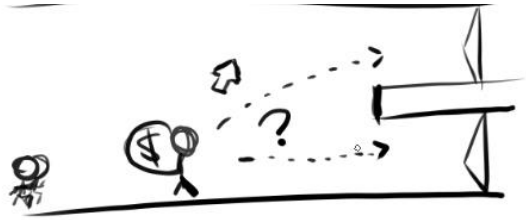
Gameplay

The Core Gameplay Loop in ISAAAOMFJBANEAEITCICM looks somewhat like this diagram;



The player starts each game in the personal safe of Jeff Bezos, in a massive castle mansion complex situated on an island, connecting to a city through one bridge towards the entrance. There, they will encounter different sized burlap, each situated on top of pedestals with a dollar sign symbol embroidered on the side as if they were being displayed. The player is required to pick one of these sacks to steal, each of them having a sum of money inside of them, increasingly correlating with the size of each sack. By choosing which sack to steal, the player will determine their movement speed, and the number of guards they must outrun. The larger the sack, the slower, and the more guards there are in each level. Once they choose a sack, the pedestal sinks into the ground like in 'Indiana Jones', an alarm sounds, and the player is required run with the sack out of the safe.

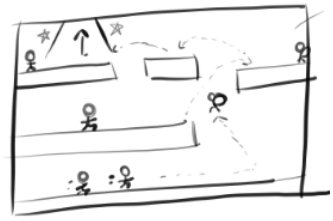
The player is now required to make their escape by platforming and finding their way through the maze of Jeff Bezos' mansion. They will encounter crossroads in which they must think on the fly choosing which direction they think is the fastest way to the exit, they will encounter puzzles that they must solve while being pressured by time, they will also encounter enemies that they must maneuver around and outsmart, after encountering these enemies will proceed to chase the player until the end of the level.



If the player encounters the enemy and they fail to outsmart them, the enemies will doggy-pile on top of the player, the player will then be given a short opportunity spam buttons until they are free, once they slip through the grasp of the enemy, the player will have dropped some money from their bag, as well as lose and item of clothing, indicating that they have a limited amount of 'chances' before they can no longer slip through again for the rest of the game.

This gameplay loop will continue until either the player loses all their chances and gets caught by the enemy AI, or the player reaches the end of the level, in which they will proceed to the next, and will repeat the process until the end of the game.

Each level will have multiple ways of going through it, with branching paths that range in difficulty, and in different directions lead to the end of the level. The player will have an indicator on the screen telling them the general direction they need to go; however, this does not indicate which path is the fastest/easiest.



There will be 3 levels in the entirety of the game. Starting in the halls of Jeff Bezos' mansion, then through the sewers beneath the castle, and finally through the streets in the nearby city.

The player will have a selection of tools and controls to help them maneuver the level and outsmart the enemy AI, including the ability to jump, to grapple, to wall jump, to boost/dodge/tackle, and to throw a decoy to distract the enemy.

The player can pick up some extra cash from around the level to add to their score.

The player wins by getting to the end of the game, and their score is determined by how much money they have stolen by the end of the game. The player loses if they are caught by enemy AI more than 3 times, where they will be given a game over screen and must restart the game from the beginning (the player will have escaped jail before they try again).

The challenge of the game is to outmaneuver the enemy ai, think on the fly, and master the movement controls so that you can get to the end of the game and win.

Interactive Elements

- Burlap Sacks of money
    - The size correlates to the number of enemy AI and movement speed of the player
- Extra cash lying around in the level

    - Increases the end score also further slows down the player by a marginal degree.
- Enemies
    - Will chase the player once encountered for the first time.
    - If they catch the player, they will take one of the players chances and decrease the end score.
    - Encourages risk taking and exploration of level.
- Level
    - There will be times where the player will have to figure out a small puzzle in the level in order to progress, they will be pressured in time to solve each puzzle.
    - There will be times where the player is stuck at a crossroads and they have quickly decide the direction they think is the easiest and safest way through.

General Game Aesthetic

The mood that ISAAAOMFJBANEAEITCICM conforms to is one of light-heartedness, expressiveness, and comedy, however has sociopolitical undertones. This is intended to be reflected in the art-style, narrative, and within the game design itself.

The art style will find itself like 'Hollow Knight' with its illustrated art style, 'Castlevania: Symphony of the Night' for its vibe and settings, and the movie 'Lupin the Third: Castle of Cagliostro' for its expressiveness in its animations, and the breath-taking views painted in the production of the film.

The idea of the narrative in this game is that the player is an un-named thief, in a world where the top class are getting absurdly rich, while at the same time the poor are needlessly suffering, struggling to get by day to day because all of the wealth is being accumulated and being stored and used for nothing. Therefore the player is stealing from one such member of the top class; a man named Jeff Bezos, with the intent to disperse the money to help the group of humanity that is struggling. Why? Because no one else will. However Jeff Bezos does not approve of his money being taken from him, therefore he orders his army of low income, abused employees to all catch the un-named thief, therefore the thief (and subsequently the player) is forced to run away from this horde of people with the money in order to fulfil his mission.

Control Scheme